Extra Questions — Ask These On The Call

The online intake gives you the facts. These questions give you the story — and the story is what the plan is built on. Ask in order; the last group matters most. Write answers on the Review sheet as you go.

About the person (in their words)

- How would you describe a normal day for them — start to finish?
- What do they love doing? What is hard for them right now?
- Who are their doctors? Any hospital stays this year?
- School or work: where, how many hours, any problems lately?

SSA history — the part the form can't tell you

- Have you ever applied before? When — and what did the letter say?
- Any denial? What is the date on that letter (the deadline lives there)?
- Who gets the check / who is the representative payee?
- Has the young adult ever worked? Any job, even a few hours?

Money — real numbers, gently

- What money comes in each month, and from where?
- Any bank account over $2,000 in their name? (This matters for SSI.)
- What bill hurts the most every month?
- Any debts or collections calling the house?

Medication

- Full medicine list — can you read me the bottles, or send a photo of the list?
- What do you pay each month for medicine right now?
- Which pharmacy? Has a medicine ever been too much to pick up?

Protection

- If something happened to you tomorrow, who takes over — and is that written anywhere?
- Any life insurance at all — even through a job?
- Are the beneficiaries on old policies still the right people?

Home & daily life

- Where will they live in 5 years — is that the plan you want, or just what happened?
- How do they get to doctors, work, or programs?
- Who helps every day — and what happens when that person can't?

Goals & worries — ask these last, and listen

- What worries you most at night about their future?
- If we could fix ONE thing this year, what would it be?
- Who else helps you make decisions — should they be on our next call?
- Is there anything you were hoping I would ask, that I didn't?

Close every call with: “Here is what I heard you need first: _____. I will send your results page by email. Then you choose — I build your plan, I guide you on Zoom, or just the one thing you need. No pressure.” — Office only: never promise an approval or a date SSA will decide.